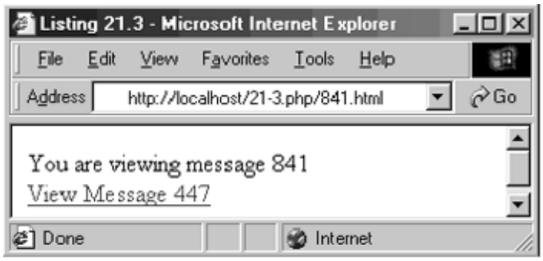
*Listing 3 Using Path Info*




We have introduced only the essential principles of this method. There are a few pitfalls, and a few enhancements to be pursued. Keep in mind that **Web browsers** do their best to fill in relative URLs, and using path information this way may foil their attempts to request images that appear in your scripts. Therefore, you must use absolute paths. You might also wish to name your PHP script so that it does not contain an extension. This is possible with Apache by setting the default document type, using the DefaultType configuration directive.

Keyword

**Web browser** is application software for accessing the World Wide Web. When a user requests a web page from a particular website, the web browser retrieves the necessary content from a web server and then displays the page on the user's device.

## 9.8 RUNNING A SCRIPT REGULARLY

Both UNIX and Windows NT have facilities for running programs according to a schedule. In UNIX you can edit your crontab file, and in Windows you use the scheduling service. These are useful when you wish to perform some maintenance function as part of your PHP-powered site. You may write a script to download the list of files at the Slashdot site. Another script might rebuild the index for a local search engine. Both crontab and the scheduling service take a command line and execute it at a given time. If you're not familiar with the details, either read the main page for crontab, or type at /? in a Windows command shell.

You have two choices for invoking a PHP script from the command line. If you have PHP as a stand-alone executable, you can call it and use the path to the script for the only argument. This is probably the way to go on a Windows machine, because the installation provides php.exe. A UNIX installation likely will be compiled as an Apache module, and no stand-alone executable will be available. In this case, you